Pemetrexed + Cisplatin

These two chemotherapy medicines aim to control the cancer. Your team will explain the expected benefit for you.

> **Check your treatment:** This summary covers the two chemotherapy medicines. If nivolumab is part of your treatment before surgery, use the full nivolumab combination plan.

Your treatment plan

Pemetrexed and cisplatin are given by drip on Day 1, then repeated every 21 days (3 weeks), if your team confirms it is safe.

1. **Before starting**

Blood tests and a review of your health. Start folic acid and arrange your vitamin B12 injection.

2. **Treatment and time at home**

Both medicines on Day 1. Extra IV fluids help protect your kidneys. Follow your medicines plan at home.

3. **Review and next steps**

Usually 4–6 cycles for the chemotherapy-only course. Your team confirms the number and the next step. Pemetrexed maintenance, if planned, is a separate phase.

Before and between visits

- Start folic acid and arrange vitamin B12 before treatment; follow your prescription.
- Ask for one clear steroid and anti-sickness schedule; do not add duplicate steroid courses.
- Tell your team about hearing problems, numbness, other medicines and any infection.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately for temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital’s temperature instructions.

Cannot reach the team? Seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Your contact plan

Ask your team to complete these before you leave.

Hospital / team _____

Daytime number and hours _____

Evening / weekend number _____

If unavailable, where to go _____

Keep this with your consent information. Ask your team about anything unclear.

What to watch for

Use the picture and symptom descriptions together. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1. Ears / hearing

Cisplatin

Report tinnitus or hearing change promptly; describe any existing problem before starting.

2. Mouth

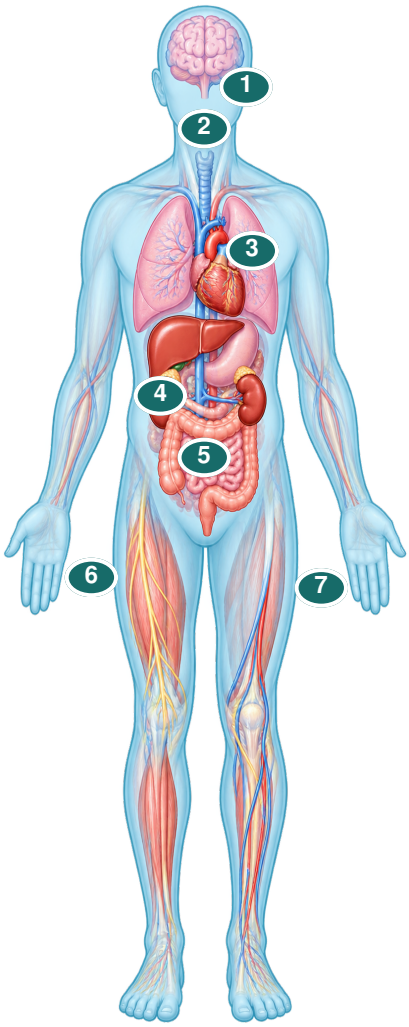
Pemetrexed

Mouth ulcers or painful swallowing can limit eating and drinking. Seek advice early.

3. Chest / breathing

Both chemotherapy medicines

New breathlessness, wheeze or chest pain needs urgent assessment; do not assume it is an expected side effect.



4. Kidneys / fluids

Both chemotherapy medicines

Report reduced urine, inability to drink, swelling or dehydration. Kidney tests guide treatment.

5. Stomach / bowel

Both chemotherapy medicines

Use prescribed anti-sickness medicines. Severe vomiting, diarrhoea or poor intake needs urgent advice.

6. Hands / feet

Cisplatin

Report tingling, numbness or difficulty with buttons, balance or walking; symptoms can persist.

7. Skin / blood counts

Both chemotherapy medicines

Report a spreading rash, unusual bruising or bleeding. Fever or sudden illness needs urgent advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Match each number to its symptom box. Blood, skin and nerve markers are schematic.

Call urgently for fever or shaking chills, sudden illness, new or worsening breathlessness, chest pain, uncontrolled bleeding, severe or persistent diarrhoea, inability to drink, very little urine, a spreading or blistering rash, or swelling/wheeze during an infusion. Tell the team promptly about new tinnitus, hearing change, numbness, weakness or difficulty walking.

My SACT card

Pemetrexed + Cisplatin
Day 1 drips; repeat every 3 weeks.

I am receiving chemotherapy. Infection can be serious even without a fever. Contact my oncology team promptly if I become unwell.

Name: _____
Hospital: _____
Oncology phone: _____
Out of hours: _____

Show this card when seeking care. It does not replace a medicine-specific alert card.

More information, when you want it

Scan for medicines, tests, daily life and your treatment record.

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00317/